

ANIME

Attack on Titan: The Final Season Part 2

★★★★★ | After almost a decade, Attack on Titan has finally come to an end. Or so we thought. Turns out, part 2 of the Final Season was not the last season of Attack on Titan, and we're going to need to wait another year to finally conclude the series.

That being said, The Final Season part 2 is some of the best Attack on Titan has to offer; it continues right where part 1 left off where we see Eren's descent into a full-on villain. Spoilers ahead if you haven't watched the show yet. Since the start of the series, Eren Yeager has been the heart of the show, and he still is



even though he's now the ultimate baddy who wants to flatten the Earth and kill everyone outside of Paradis Island. However, the signs have always been there. Eren doesn't just drop everything and go insane. Everything he's feeling now, he's been feeling since day one, and the show does a good job showing this to us.

Every move he's been making has been calculated, including his alliance with his half brother, Zeke. Then there's the major plot point, the Attack titan's ability to see memories from both the past and the future, and Eren using this to his advantage to control events from the past.

Part 2 of season five does a good job of further exploring new and existing cast members. Connie, Jean, Armin and Mikasa have to come to terms with fighting and killing their own people if they want to save the world. Meanwhile, Gabi, who was despised for killing Sasha, gets some serious character development, which almost makes you want to root for her. She also conveys another message, about how the war affects children the worst.

Part 2 has a few pacing issues, and then there's the fact that it doesn't actually end and you need to wait an entire year to find out how the show ends. Other than those two things, part 2 is one of the best arcs of Attack on Titan so far.

—Manish Rajesh

TV SHOW

The Wheel of Time

★★★☆☆ | Based on Robert Jordan's fantasy epic, Amazon's The Wheel of Time is a big budget (\$90 million!) fantasy show, which was probably made with the intention of filling the Game of Thrones void. I need to preface this review by saying that I haven't read the books. I don't know if the show is true to the source material or not. From what I've heard or read online from people who are familiar with the source material, the show has definitely taken plenty of creative liberties with the plot.

Coming back to the show, in short, Wheel of Time is alright. The pacing early on is very slow, picks up a bit in between, and then towards the end it almost feels like they pulled a reason for season two out of a hat. Up until that point it didn't



seem like anything of the sort would happen, it just kinda does.

There have been many comparisons drawn between The Wheel of Time and The Lord of Rings; you've got five young protagonists, each of whom could be the next Dragon Reborn. They journey with a

mentor figure, Moiraine, who is Aes Sedai – one of the mages of this world. Their quest is to beat the Dark One, a powerful dark force that threatens to engulf the world in shadows and darkness. Only the Dragon Reborn can stop the Dark One, or fall to temptation and help the Dark One achieve his goals.

The story begins with Moiraine travelling to the Two Rivers to recruit them and embark on a journey to the White Tower, where they will prepare to face the Dark One. Do you see the parallels yet?

Ultimately, The Wheel of Time kind of falls flat. It is disappointing for a \$90 million budget show, and we certainly expected more. The pacing was off, there were too many inconsistencies, there's no real connection viewers can feel with the characters and the final episode seemingly pulls a reason for a sequel out of nowhere. Nevertheless, we're still willing to give the sequel a chance, for the gorgeous world building if not anything else.

—Manish Rajesh